

From the Inside Out

Recognizing why we need God's revival in our lives

"For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God" - Romans 3:23

We are all sinners; we all fall short of the glory of God. In the eyes of our perfect God, the wages of sin is death (Romans 6:23) and an eternal separation from God. However, the story doesn't end there, as in the following verses (Romans 6:23-25), we see that Jesus has saved us from the eternal judgment that we deserve. Though we are still sinners, God loves us enough to send Jesus to die for our sins (Romans 5:8) and bridge the gap between us and God.

After recognizing this truth, we should examine the inside of our hearts. Receiving the gospel is admitting that we have sinned and fallen short of the glory of God, that we need God, and in faith receive Jesus Christ as our Saviour.

"But to all who did receive him, who believed in his name, he gave the right to become children of God." - John 1:12

Becoming a child of God isn't a one-time thing, though. No matter where we are in our walks of faith, we need Christ to revive and refine us (2 Corinthians 5:17). And that's exactly what I hope to foster through IG3 - through meditating on God's word, prayer, and forming Godly relationships to encourage each other to pursue a genuine relationship with God, as His children.

Recognizing what God can do in our community

"And let us consider how to stir up one another to love and good works, not neglecting to meet together, as is the habit of some, but encouraging one another, and all the more as you see the Day drawing near." - Hebrews 10:24-25

For many of us, myself included, we can lose sight of God in the social aspect of the wonderful community at CCF. However, my challenge for IG3 is not just to be a community of good friends, but a God-centred community that encourages each other to seek a genuine relationship with God.

More specifically, this can look like:

- Prayerful living in groups and in our personal lives (struggles, praising, glorifying God)
- Pointing each other to God's Word (for "training in righteousness" - 2 Timothy 3:16)
- Asking heart-oriented questions ("What has the Holy Spirit been doing in your heart?")
- Openly sharing about our faith (e.g., why we believe) and our struggles (with sin and/or with doubts)
- Loving one another in fellowship (so that God may be glorified - John 13:34-35)

While I hope to create an environment where all of these things can thrive, a God-centred

community is fostered through every person in IG3. We are not alone in our faith journeys; we can build each other up in faith and be mutually encouraged by God's work in each of our lives. And through a God-centered community, we can be revived by God from the inside out.

"For I long to see you, that I may impart to you some spiritual gift to strengthen you - that is, that we may be mutually encouraged by each other's faith, both yours and mine."

- Romans 1:11-12

Recognizing how we should respond beyond our community

"You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden. Nor do people light a lamp and put it under a basket, but on a stand, and it gives light to all in the house. In the same way, let your light shine before others, so that they may see your good works and give glory to your Father who is in heaven." - Matthew 5:14-16

